

PARTICIPANT NUMBER _____

GROUP NUMBER _____

“Vermont’s Energy Future” Final Survey

We’d like get your views on these issues one last time. We’d just like to know what you think about them now, after this weekend of discussion. If you come to a question you don’t have much opinion about, just say so and move on to the next one.

1. On a 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is “not at all”, 10 is “a great deal,” and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much would you say you care about how the electricity you use is produced?

Please circle the appropriate number

Not at all					Exactly in the middle					A great deal
0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

2. Some people think Vermont should meet as much of its electricity needs as possible by increasing the efficiency with which Vermont consumers use electricity. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think Vermont should meet its electricity needs entirely by generating or buying more electricity. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in-between are at point 4, and of course other people have opinions at other points between 1 and 7. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or wouldn’t you have any opinion about that?

Please circle the appropriate number

As much as possible by increasing efficiency			Exactly in-between			Entirely by generating or buying more electricity		No opinion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7		99

3. And what percentage of the electricity Vermont consumes would you *like* to see come from each of the following generation related sources over the next 10 years?

Please enter numbers between 0 and 100

	Percentage
a. Wind	
b. Oil	
c. Natural gas	
d. Coal	
e. Nuclear	
f. Solar	

g. Hydro	
h. Wood	
i. Methane from farms or landfill	

4. Now think about people who would answer that last question very differently—who would enter very different percentages from you just did. How strongly would you agree or disagree that even if they are wrong they often have good reason for their views.

Please circle the appropriate number

Agree strongly	Agree somewhat	Neither agree nor disagree	Disagree somewhat	Disagree strongly	No opinion
1	2	3	4	5	99

5. Some people think Vermont's electric utilities should meet the state's future energy needs by contracting to buy electricity from other providers. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think Vermont's electric utilities should meet the state's future electricity needs by building their own facilities. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. Again people who are exactly in-between are at point 4, and again of course other people have opinions at other points between 1 and 7. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

Please circle the appropriate number

Buy from other providers			Exactly in-between			Build own facilities		No opinion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7		99

6. Next we'd like know how strongly you agree or disagree with each of the following statements.

Please circle the appropriate number

	Agree strongly	Agree somewhat	Neither agree nor disagree	Disagree somewhat	Disagree strongly	No opinion
a. Vermont should continue to purchase electricity from Hydro Quebec.	1	2	3	4	5	99
b. Vermont should continue to purchase electricity from the Vermont Yankee nuclear power plant.	1	2	3	4	5	99
c. Vermont should continue to purchase electricity from the Vermont based independent Power Producers, producing electricity from hydro and wood chips.	1	2	3	4	5	99

d. The price Vermonters pay for electricity should be higher when the cost of generating it is higher and lower when the cost of generating it is lower.	1	2	3	4	5	99
e. Vermont should require that a minimum percentage of the electricity sold to Vermonters come from renewable sources.	1	2	3	4	5	99

7. If Vermont *were* to require that a minimum percentage of the electricity sold to Vermonters come from renewable sources, what percentage should that be? **(Please enter a number between 0 and 100.)**

_____ %

8. And would you like to see the electricity used by Vermonters produced ...?

Please circle the appropriate number

Entirely inside Vermont	1
Mostly inside Vermont	2
About half and half, inside and outside Vermont	3
Mostly outside Vermont	4
Entirely outside Vermont	5
No opinion	99

9. Here are some questions about the locations of electric generation facilities that could conceivably be built in Vermont. On a scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is "strongly opposed," 10 is "strongly in favor," and 5 is exactly in the middle, how would you say you feel about having each of these types of facilities built in Vermont?

Please circle the appropriate number

	Strongly opposed					Exactly in the middle					Strongly in favor		No opinion
Facilities that produce electricity ...													
a. Using wind	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
b. Using natural gas	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
c. Using biomass, like woodchips	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99

d. From hydropower	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
e. From oil	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
f. From landfill or farm methane	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99

10. Some people would like to have electric bills that don't change too much from year to year, even if their electricity may wind up costing quite a bit more than the market price. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people would like to get their electricity at the market price, even if their bills may go up and down by quite a bit from year to year. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in-between are at point 4. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

Please circle the appropriate number

Bills that don't change too much from year to year			Exactly in-between			Getting electricity at the market price		No opinion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7		99

11. Some people think that Vermont's electricity should be produced by a few large, centralized plants. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think that it should be produced by smaller facilities, spread across the state. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

Please circle the appropriate number

A few large, centralized plants			Exactly in-between			Smaller facilities, spread across the state		No opinion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7		99

12. How strongly would you support or oppose a wind farm being built if it were visible from where you live, or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

Please circle the appropriate number

Support it strongly	1
Support it somewhat	2
Neither support nor oppose it	3
Oppose it somewhat	4
Oppose it strongly	5
No opinion	9

13. Over the next ten years would you like to see Vermont increase the funding for its energy efficiency program, decrease it, or keep it about the same level, or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

Please circle the appropriate number

Increase it	1
Keep it about the same	2
Decrease it	3
No opinion	9

14. And over the next ten years would you like to see Vermont increase the percentage of electricity it uses that comes from renewable resources, decrease the percentage or keep it at about the same level?

Please circle the appropriate number

Increase it	1
Keep it about the same	2
Decrease it	3
No opinion	9

15. How many dollars more per month would you be willing to pay, if necessary, for electricity that came entirely from sources that produced no greenhouse gases, other pollutants, or nuclear wastes? **(Enter a number of dollars; if you wouldn't be willing to pay any more for this, just enter 0.)**

\$

16. How many dollars more per month would you be willing to pay, if necessary, to get Hydro Quebec to provide power exclusively from their wind resources? **(Enter a number of dollars; if you wouldn't be willing to pay any more for this, just enter 0.)**

\$

17. How many dollars more per month would you be willing to pay, if necessary, to ensure that all your electricity was generated by in-state resources? **(Enter a number of dollars; if you wouldn't be willing to pay any more for this, just enter 0.)**

\$

18. How many dollars extra in your monthly utility bill would you be willing to pay, if necessary, to ensure that all your electricity was generated by smaller, decentralized plants? **(Enter a number of dollars; if you wouldn't be willing to pay any more for this, just enter 0.)**

\$

19. Now a question about *how* Vermont should invest in additional renewable resources, to the extent that it decides to do that. Some people think that the cost of additional renewable resources should be divided among all customers. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think individual customers should be asked how much electricity from renewable resources they would like to buy and that Vermont should *only* acquire enough renewable energy to meet that demand even though all would benefit. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

Please circle the appropriate number

Divide costs among all customers			Exactly in-between			Only acquire enough renewable energy to meet the demand customers express		No opinion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7		99

20. On a scale of a scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is extremely *unfriendly* to the environment, 10 is extremely friendly to it, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how environmentally friendly or unfriendly would you say each of the following sources is?

Please circle the appropriate number

	Extremely unfriendly					Exactly in the middle					Extremely friendly		No opinion
a. Wind	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
b. Oil	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
c. Natural gas	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
d. Coal	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
e. Nuclear	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
f. Solar	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
g. Hydro	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
h. Wood	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
i. Methane from farms or landfill	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
j. Energy efficiency	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99

21. On another scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is extremely *unconcerned*, 10 is extremely concerned, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how concerned do you are you about each of the following?

Please circle the appropriate number

	Extremely unconcerned					Exactly in the					Extremely concerned		No opinion
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						middle							
a. Radioactive waste from nuclear power plants	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
b. Greenhouse gases produced by burning fuel to make electricity	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
c. Other air pollution produced by burning fuel to make electricity	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
d. Damage to river habitats from building hydro power facilities	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
e. The visual impact of wind farms on the scenery of Vermont	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99

22. And on another scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is no threat at all, 10 is an extremely serious threat, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much of a threat to Vermont's scenic beauty would you say is posed by locating each of the following electricity sources in Vermont?

Please circle the appropriate number

	Extremely unconcerned					Exactly in the middle						Extremely concerned		No opinion
a. A coal-fired electric generating plant	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10			99
b. A natural gas-fired electric generating plant	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10			99
c. A utility scale wind farm	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10			99
d. A residential scale wind farm	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10			99
e. Electricity transmission lines	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10			99

23. By about what percentage do you believe Vermont's need for electricity *could* be reduced by increasing the efficiency with which Vermont consumers use electricity by 2017? **(Please enter a number between 0 and 100.)**

_____ %

24. About what percentage of the electricity consumed by Vermonters would you say *could* possibly be provided by each of the following by 2017?

Please enter numbers between 0 and 100

	Percentage
a. Wind	
b. Oil	
c. Natural gas	
d. Coal	
e. Nuclear	
f. Solar	
g. Hydro	
h. Wood	
i. Methane from farms or landfill	

25. How strongly would agree or disagree with each of the following statements.

Please circle the appropriate number

	Agree strongly	Agree somewhat	Neither agree nor disagree	Disagree somewhat	Disagree strongly	No opinion
a. Cleaner energy will cost more in the <i>short</i> run.	1	2	3	4	5	99
b. Cleaner energy will cost more in the <i>long</i> run.	1	2	3	4	5	99
c. Power not purchased from Hydro Quebec would have to be replaced by natural gas, coal, out of state nuclear power, or oil.	1	2	3	4	5	99
d. Power not purchased from Vermont Yankee would have to be replaced by natural gas, coal, out of state nuclear power, or oil.	1	2	3	4	5	99

26. Some people think the weather of the past few decades is just an example of normal variation over time. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think the weather of the past decade is part of a lasting climate change. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in-between are at point 4. Where would you place yourself on this scale? Or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

Please circle the appropriate number

Normal variation over		Exactly in-		Lasting climate		No
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time			between			change		opinion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7		99

27. Some people think that human activity is responsible for any climate change that may be occurring. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think that any climate change that may be occurring is due to natural causes. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in-between are at point 4. Where would you place yourself on this scale? Or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

Please circle the appropriate number

Human activity responsible			Exactly in-between			Due to natural causes		No opinion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7		99

28. Some people think that in choosing a source for electricity only the direct costs, like those of building and operating the power generation facility and the power lines, should be considered. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think that indirect costs, like those associated with pollution, greenhouse gas emissions, or nuclear wastes, should also be considered. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in-between are at point 4, and of course other people have opinions at other points between 1 and 7. Where would you place your views on this scale?

Please circle the appropriate number

Consider only direct costs			Exactly in-between			Consider indirect costs as well		No opinion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7		99

29. Thinking about the ways in which Vermont might meet its future electricity needs, please tell me how important each of the following goals is to you using a scale of 0 to 10, with 0 being not at all important and 10 being extremely important.

Please circle the appropriate number

	Not at all important					Exactly in the middle					Extremely important		No opinion
a. Keeping electricity rates low for consumers	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
b. Keeping electric rates stable for consumers	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
c. Reducing dependence on foreign energy sources	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
d. Minimizing air pollution	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
e. Using power produced in Vermont	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99

f. Avoiding facilities that detract from the scenic beauty of Vermont	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
g. Reducing the emission of gases that may contribute to climate change	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
h. Ensuring a reliable supply of electricity	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
i. Reducing radioactive wastes	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
j. Creating jobs in Vermont	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
k. Getting electricity from resources that will never be used up	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99

Now we come to some questions to which not everyone may know the right answers. If you come to one to which you don't know the answer, just circle the number for "Couldn't say," and move on to the next one.

30. Is the surcharge Vermonters pay on their electric bills for programs to reduce the need for electricity currently ...?

Please circle the appropriate number

Zero—there is no surcharge	1
About half a cent per kilowatt hour*	2
About two cents per kilowatt hour	3
About five cents per kilowatt hour	4
About seven-and-a-half cents per kilowatt hour	5
Couldn't say	99

31. What effect has Vermont's energy efficiency program had on the annual increase in the amount of electricity used by Vermonter's? Has it

Please circle the appropriate number

Had almost no impact on the increase	1
Reduced it by 20%	2
Reduced it by 50%*	3
Reduced it by 70%	4
Reduced it by 90%	5
Couldn't say	99

32. Excluding Hydro Quebec, about what percentage of its electricity does Vermont currently get from renewable resources?

Please circle the appropriate number

5%	1
15%*	2
25%*	3
40%	4
Couldn't say	99

33. And about what percentage of its electricity Does Vermont currently get from the Vermont Yankee nuclear plant?

Please circle the appropriate number

5%	1
10%	2
20%	3
33% *	4
Couldn't say	99

34. About what percentage of its electricity does Vermont currently get from Hydro Quebec?

Please circle the appropriate number

15%	1
33%*	2
45%	3
60%	4
Couldn't say	99

35. Roughly what percentage of Vermont's electricity is currently generated within Vermont?

Please circle the appropriate number

12%	1
33%	2
55%*	3
72%	4
Couldn't say	99

36. How do Vermont's electricity rates compare with those of the rest of New England? Are they, on average, ...

Please circle the appropriate number

Roughly 20%% higher	1
Roughly 10%% higher	2
About the same	3
Roughly 10%% lower*	4
Roughly 20%% lower	5
Couldn't say	99

37. What is the average electric bill for the typical Vermonter? Is it ...

Please circle the appropriate number

Roughly \$60	1
Roughly \$80*	2
Roughly \$120	3
Roughly \$180	4
Couldn't say	99

38. Does Vermont's contract with the Vermont Yankee nuclear power plant expire in ...

Please circle the appropriate number

2010	1
2012*	2
2018	3
2025	4
Couldn't say	99

Now a few questions about this weekend:

39. On a scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is "a waste of time", 10 is "extremely valuable," and 5 is exactly in the middle, how valuable was each of the following in helping you clarify your positions on the issues?

Please circle the appropriate number

	A waste of time					Exactly in the middle					Extremely valuable		No opinion
a. Participating in the small group discussions	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
b. Meeting and talking to other participants outside of the formal discussions	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
c. The event as a whole	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99

40. And how strongly would you agree or disagree with each of the following statements?

Please circle the appropriate number

	Agree strongly	Agree somewhat	Neither agree nor disagree	Disagree somewhat	Disagree strongly	No opinion
a. My small group moderator provided the opportunity for everyone to participate in the discussion	1	2	3	4	5	99
b. The members of my small group participated relatively equally in the discussions	1	2	3	4	5	99
c. My small group moderator sometimes tried to influence the group with this or her own views	1	2	3	4	5	99

d. My small group moderator tried to make sure that opposing arguments were considered	1	2	3	4	5	99
e. The important aspects of the issues were covered in the group discussions	1	2	3	4	5	99
f. I learned a lot about people very different from me—about what they and their lives are like	1	2	3	4	5	99
g. The briefing document presented competing arguments fairly	1	2	3	4	5	99

41. **Before the deliberation started**, how much of the briefing material you were sent would you say you had read?

Please circle the appropriate number

Hadn't read or had just glanced at it	1
Had read less than half of it	2
Had read about half of it	3
Had read more than half of it	4
Had read all or nearly all of it	5

42. **And by the end of the deliberations**, how much of the briefing material you were sent would you say you had read?

Please circle the appropriate number

Hadn't read or had just glanced at it	1
Had read less than half of it	2
Had read about half of it	3
Had read more than half of it	4
Had read all or nearly all of it	5

43. On a scale from 0 to 10, where 0 is not at all important, 10 is extremely important, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how important was each of the following in your decision to attend this event ...?

Please circle the appropriate number

	Not Important at all					Exactly in the middle					Extremely Important		No opinion
The prospect of discussing an interesting topic	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
Getting to meet people from across the state	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
The possibility of being mentioned in the newspaper	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
The possibility of being seen on TV	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
Getting to question policy experts and policy makers	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
The honorarium of \$150	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
A paid-for weekend in a nice hotel	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
A paid-for weekend in Burlington	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
The chance of making your voice heard	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99
The chance of affecting energy policy	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		99

Finally, a few more questions about you:

44. Which of the following broad income categories best describes your total household income before taxes in 2006? Would it be ...

Please circle the appropriate number

Less than \$25,000	1
Between \$25,000 and \$50,000	2
Between \$50,000 and \$75,000	3
Between \$75,000 and \$100,000	4
Between \$100,000 and \$125,000	5
Between \$125,000 and \$150,000	6
More than \$150,000	7
Rather not say	99

45. In politics, people often talk about “liberal” and “conservative.” On a scale from 1 to 7, where 1 is extremely liberal, 7 is extremely conservative, and 4 is exactly in the middle, how liberal or conservative would you say you are, or wouldn’t you have any opinion about that?

PLEASE CIRCLE THE APPROPRIATE NUMBER

Extremely liberal			Exactly in the middle			Extremely conservative		No opinion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7		99

46. And generally speaking, would say that you usually think of yourself as a Democrat, a Republican, an independent, or what?

Please circle the appropriate number

Democrat	1
Republican	2
Independent	3
Other (specify) _____	4
None of the above	9

That’s all! Thank you for your participation! We hope you’ve had a great time talking with one another and thinking through your views on these issues. You will receive your check when you hand in this completed survey. Have a safe trip home! Again many thanks!